Evaluation Rubric & Anchored Scoring Scale

Official Horizon/NSF Scoring Standards

Each criterion (Technical Excellence, Impact, Budget & Implementation) is evaluated on a calibrated scale from 0.0 to 5.0 (half-points allowed: 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, ..., 5.0).

Evaluators are strictly prohibited from giving generic unqualified praise. Every assigned mark MUST cite verbatim evidentiary excerpts (page/section) from the proposal dossier.

Anchored Score Definitions

- **Score 0 (Fail / Non-compliant)**:

The proposal fails to address the criterion under examination or cannot be judged due to missing information.

- **Score 1 (Poor)**:

The criterion is addressed in an inadequate manner, or there are serious inherent weaknesses. Core methodologies are obsolete or missing essential safeguards.

- **Score 2 (Fair)**:

While the proposal broadly addresses the criterion, there are significant weaknesses. For example: theoretical claims lack validation plans, or direct cost breakdowns exhibit arithmetical inconsistencies.

- **Score 3 (Good)**:

The proposal addresses the criterion well, with several strengths, but a number of shortcomings are present. Methodologies are sound but rely on standard solutions without significant innovation, or risk mitigation lacks depth.

- **Score 4 (Very Good)**:

The proposal addresses the criterion very well, with a high degree of excellence. Minor shortcomings are present but do not jeopardize feasibility or outcomes. Strong evidence, well-calibrated figures, and thorough risk matrices.

- **Score 5 (Excellent)**:

The proposal successfully addresses all relevant aspects of the criterion in an exemplary fashion. Any shortcomings are purely cosmetic. Groundbreaking methodology, flawless budget breakdown, comprehensive dissemination, and fully reproducible open science plan.

Evidence & Traceability Rule

Any score assertion without an explicit page/section citation and quoted excerpt is considered invalid. The automated panel verifier checks that cited text exists verbatim in the proposal document.